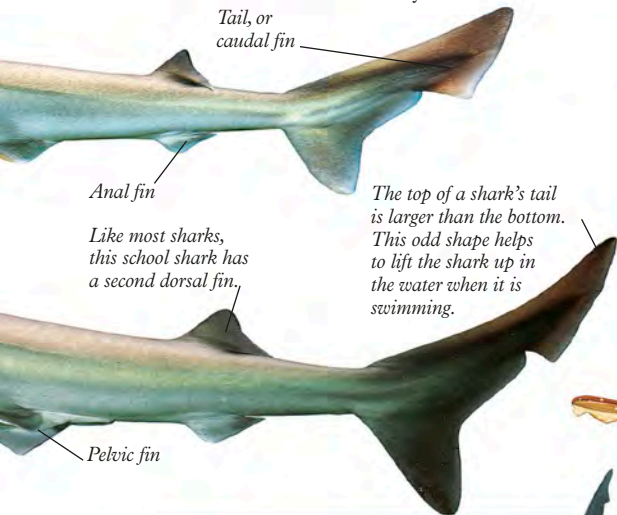




Close-up of shark skin

Watch your hands

Shark skin feels like rough sandpaper—it is covered in tiny teeth.



The top of a shark's tail is larger than the bottom. This odd shape helps to lift the shark up in the water when it is swimming.

Shark shapes

Not all sharks look like the ones you see in films; some are tiny and others are quite odd shapes.



Cookiecutter shark



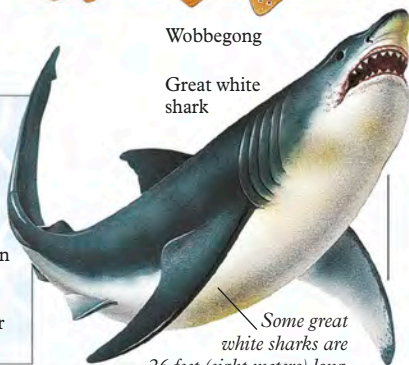
Hammerhead shark



Prickly dogfish



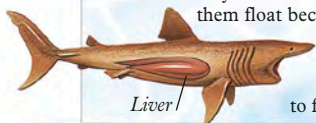
Wobbegong



Great white shark

Sink or swim

Sharks, like many fish, are heavier than water, so they should sink to the bottom of the sea. Bony fish have inflatable swim bladders to stop this from happening, but sharks have oily livers instead. The oil helps them float because it is lighter than water. There is enough oil inside a basking shark's liver to fill five big buckets!



Liver

